



Belovezhskaya Pushcha National Park

This ancient forest protects nearly 579 sq miles (1,500 sq km) of old oak, pine, and fir trees. Half of the park lies in the neighboring country of Poland, where it is called Białowieża National Park.

Belarus

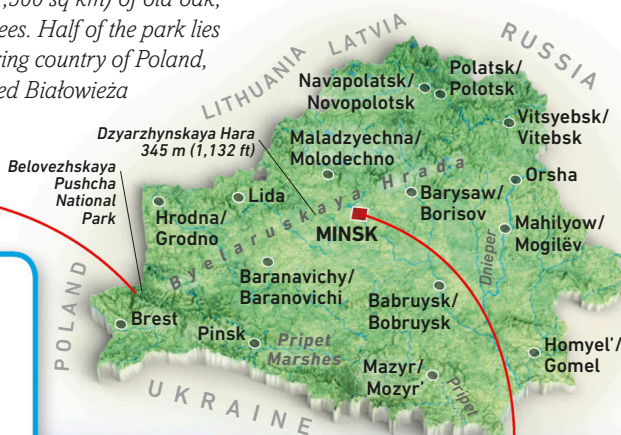


Europe



- 80,154 sq miles (207,600 sq km)
- 9.5 million
- Minsk
- Belarusian, Russian

Forest and **marshland** cover much of this **landlocked** nation, which **lies between Russia and Poland**. Belarus's rural areas are home to **wild boars, elks, wolves**, and rare **zubrs**, also known as **European bison**.



0 100 km
0 100 miles
(approximate scale)

Modern Minsk

Two rivers—the Svislač and the Nyamiha (below)—flow through Minsk, the nation's capital and industrial center.



Soroca fortress

This 15th-century fortress was built to protect Moldova from invaders. The round towers helped it resist cannon fire.

Moldova



- 13,070 sq miles (33,851 sq km)
- 3.4 million
- Chișinău
- Moldovan, Ukrainian, Russian

This landlocked nation, lying on a hilly plateau, declared its **independence** from the **Soviet Union** in 1991. **Orchards** and **vineyards** dot the country's rolling hills and produce an abundance of **fruit** and **wine**.



0 60 km
0 60 miles
(approximate scale)

Lavender harvest

Lavender thrives in Moldova's dry, warm climate and rich soil. The flowers are distilled to produce a fragrant essential oil.

